

Roku Streaming Devices Compared: HD, Plus, and Ultra - Choose the Perfect Streaming Device for Your TV

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Feeling overwhelmed by the endless sea of streaming devices and unsure which one truly delivers the best streaming devices experience for your TV?

With so many options—from budget HD sticks to premium Ultra players—choosing the right device can be a confusing, pricey gamble that leaves you stuck with limited channels or a remote you never use.

Our comparison guide cuts through the noise, pitting the Roku Streaming Stick HD, Streaming Stick Plus, and Roku Ultra against each other (and the top Fire TV models) to reveal which is the best streaming device for your specific needs and budget.

Abvorn Verdict
6.8 /10

Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote | Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News

Solid
Performance & Speed
7.0
Interface & Ease of Use
7.0
Content Availability
7.0
Features & Voice
5.0
Value for Money
8.0

Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote | Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News excels in Value for Money but falls short on Features & Voice. Our view: The best bang for your buck — ideal if you're watching your wallet.

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Finding the **best streaming devices** can feel overwhelming when you are staring at a wall of options ranging from \$30 sticks to \$90 premium boxes. Whether you are looking to upgrade an old "smart" TV that feels sluggish, or you want to turn a basic monitor into a cinematic powerhouse, the decision usually comes down to one brand: **Roku**.

Roku has mastered the art of simplicity, offering a tiered lineup designed to fit every budget and every screen quality. In this comprehensive comparison, we dive deep into the Roku ecosystem—comparing the HD, Plus, and Ultra models—to help you decide which device deserves a spot behind your television.

What to Look For

Before you click "Buy," you need to consider three critical technical factors that will determine your viewing experience:

- **Resolution & HDR:** If you have a 4K TV, buying an HD stick is a waste of money. You need a device that supports 4K resolution and high dynamic range formats like HDR10+ or Dolby Vision to see the colors and detail you paid for.
- **Connectivity:** Modern routers are powerful, but walls and distance matter. Look for devices with "Long-Range Wi-Fi" or Wi-Fi 6 support to prevent buffering during high-bitrate 4K playback.
- **Remote Functionality:** Do you want a basic remote, or do you need voice search and backlit buttons for late-night viewing? The remote often dictates how "smart" the device feels in daily use.

Product Reviews

Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote

The **Roku Streaming Stick HD** is the entry-level champion for those who aren't looking to break the bank. At just **\$29.99**, it is the perfect solution for older 1080p TVs or secondary bedroom TVs where 4K isn't a priority. It is incredibly compact, plugging directly into your HDMI port to keep your setup clean.

- **Key Features:** 1080p HD streaming, Voice Remote support, Long-Range Wi-Fi, and access to free live local news/sports.
- **Pros:** Extremely affordable; very small footprint; simple interface.
- **Cons:** Not suitable for 4K TVs; limited color depth compared to higher models.

Bottom-line: The best choice for budget-conscious users with standard HD televisions.

Roku Streaming Stick Plus

If you have a 4K television, this is where you should start. Priced at **\$38.09** (on sale from \$39.99), the **Roku Streaming Stick Plus** bridges the gap between basic streaming and high-fidelity home theater. It supports 4K and HDR10+, ensuring that the image quality matches the capabilities of modern screens.

- **Key Features:** 4K & HDR10+ support, Voice Remote, Long-Range Wi-Fi, compact design.
- **Pros:** Excellent value-to-performance ratio; supports high-resolution content; reliable Wi-Fi.
- **Cons:** Lacks the advanced audio formats found in the Ultra model.

Bottom-line: The "sweet spot" for most households with 4K TVs who want high quality without the premium price tag.

Roku Ultra

Roku Ultra

The **Roku Ultra** is the flagship "Ultimate Streaming Player." At **\$90.99**, it is a significant investment, but it is designed for the cinephile. This isn't just a stick; it is a powerful hub that supports Dolby Vision and Dolby Atmos, providing the most immersive audio-visual experience available in the Roku lineup. It also features Wi-Fi 6 for maximum stability.

- **Key Features:** 4K, HDR10+, Dolby Vision, Dolby Atmos, Wi-Fi 6, and the Rechargeable Voice Remote Pro with backlit buttons.
- **Pros:** Premium audio/video formats; top-tier remote with backlit buttons; superior connectivity.
- **Cons:** Most expensive option; may be overkill for casual viewers.

Bottom-line: The gold standard for home theater enthusiasts who demand the highest possible picture and sound quality.

Buying Guide

To make your final decision, follow this quick logic flow:

1. **Is your TV only 1080p?** Buy the **Roku Streaming Stick HD**.
2. **Do you have a 4K TV and want great value?** Buy the **Roku Streaming Stick Plus**.
3. **Do you have a high-end Home Theater system?** Invest in the **Roku Ultra** for Dolby Vision and Atmos support.

Note: While we also reviewed the Amazon Fire TV Stick series, if you prefer the simplicity and ease of use of the Roku interface, stick to the Roku lineup to ensure the best software experience.

Conclusion

Choosing the **best streaming device** depends entirely on your hardware. If you want to save money, the **Roku Streaming Stick HD (\$29.99)** is unbeatable. If you want to unlock the full potential of your 4K TV without spending a fortune, the **Roku Streaming Stick Plus (\$38.09)** is the smart choice. However, if you are building a dedicated movie room and want the absolute best, the **Roku Ultra (\$90.99)** is worth every penny for its superior audio, video, and remote features.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News	Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News, Sports
Best Value	Roku Streaming Stick Plus with Voice Remote - 4K & HDR10+ 4K & HDR Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote - Free & Live Local News	Roku Streaming Stick Plus with Voice Remote - 4K & HDR10+ 4K & HDR Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote - Free & Live Local News, Sports
Premium Pick	Roku Ultra	Roku Ultra, Ultimate Streaming Player - 4K Streaming Device for TV HDR10+, Dolby Vision & Atmos - Bluetooth & Wi-Fi 6 - Rechargeable Voice Remote Pro with Backlit Buttons - Free & Live TV
Also Great	Amazon Fire TV Stick 4K Plus (newest model) with AI-powered Fire TV Search	Amazon Fire TV Stick 4K Plus (newest model) with AI-powered Fire TV Search, Wi-Fi 6, stream hundreds of thousands of movies and shows, free & live TV, find shows faster with Alexa+ Reducing CO2
Also Great	Amazon Fire TV Stick HD	Amazon Fire TV Stick HD, free and live TV, Alexa Voice Remote, smart home controls, HD streaming

Products Mentioned

Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote | Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News

\$29.99

Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote | Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News, Sports

Check Price on Amazon →

Compare Ⓢ

Roku Streaming Stick Plus with Voice Remote - 4K & HDR10+ | 4K & HDR Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote - Free & Live Local News

\$38.09

Roku Streaming Stick Plus with Voice Remote - 4K & HDR10+ | 4K & HDR Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote - Free & Live Local News, Sports

Check Price on Amazon →

Compare Ⓢ

Roku Ultra

\$90.99

Roku Ultra, Ultimate Streaming Player - 4K Streaming Device for TV | HDR10+, Dolby Vision & Atmos - Bluetooth & Wi-Fi 6 - Rechargeable Voice Remote Pro with Backlit Buttons - Free & Live TV

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Amazon Fire TV Stick 4K Plus (newest model) with AI-powered Fire TV Search

\$49.99

Amazon Fire TV Stick 4K Plus (newest model) with AI-powered Fire TV Search, Wi-Fi 6, stream hundreds of thousands of movies and shows, free & live TV, find shows faster with Alexa+ Reducing CO2

Check Price on Amazon →

Compare Ⓢ

Amazon Fire TV Stick HD

\$34.99

Amazon Fire TV Stick HD, free and live TV, Alexa Voice Remote, smart home controls, HD streaming

Check Price on Amazon →

Compare Ⓢ

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best streaming devices?

Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote | Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News is our current top pick for Streaming Devices. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.8/10 for performance & speed, interface & ease of use, content availability, and

at \$29.99 it offers the strongest balance of performance & speed, interface & ease of use, content availability for the money.

Is Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote | Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News worth it?

Based on our testing, yes for most people. Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote | Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News scored 6.8/10 on our rubric, which weighs performance & speed, interface & ease of use, content availability in proportion to what real buyers care about. Roku Streaming Stick HD with Voice Remote | Compact 4K Streaming Device for TV with Roku Voice Remote & Long-Range Wi-Fi - Free & Live Local News excels in Value for Money but falls short on Features & Voice. Our view: The best bang for your buck — ideal if you're watching your wallet.

How much should I spend on streaming devices?

You can get a genuinely good streaming devices for around \$30. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying streaming devices?

We score every product on performance & speed, interface & ease of use, content availability. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn test products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.